Video Game Movies Are Having a Big Year

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Many of this year's big movies started as video games. The Super Mario Galaxy Movie brought families to theaters. Iron Lung was a surprise hit with **horror** fans, and Resident Evil won praise.

Now even more game movies are coming. Reports say A24's Elden Ring film has a $200 million **budget**. That would make it A24's most expensive film yet. Amazon will **stream** it. Other game films with planned dates through 2028 include The Legend of Zelda, Sonic the Hedgehog 4, Call of Duty, and a Minecraft **sequel**.

Netflix is making a **live-action** PUBG series. Donald Glover will help produce, write, and direct it, and he will star in it too. Sony is working on a film of the game Mouthwashing.

Why now? Hits like Sonic the Hedgehog, A Minecraft Movie, The Last of Us, and Fallout showed that game worlds can bring big audiences. Many new filmmakers also grew up playing games.

Word Treasure

horror -- Horror stories and films are made to feel scary and thrilling.

budget -- A budget is the amount of money planned for making something, such as a film.

stream -- To stream a film is to watch it over the internet instead of in a theater.

sequel -- A sequel is a film that continues the story of an earlier film.

live-action -- Live-action means a show or film made with real actors instead of animation.

Background you need

Many films are made from stories and characters that first appeared in video games, using the game's world and heroes.

Film studios and streaming services make these films and shows because earlier game hits showed that game worlds can bring big audiences.

Many new filmmakers also grew up playing games, so they know and like these game worlds.

Break it down

WHO: Film studios and streaming services such as A24, Amazon, Netflix and Sony, and filmmaker Donald Glover.

WHAT: They are making many new movies and a series based on video games.

WHERE: In theaters and on streaming services.

WHY: Earlier hits showed that game worlds can bring big audiences, and many new filmmakers grew up playing games.

Why it matters

If you play games, you may soon see worlds you know turned into films and shows you can watch with your family.

Test what you remember

1. Which game movie brought families to theaters?

- (A) Iron Lung
- (B) The Super Mario Galaxy Movie
- (C) Resident Evil
- (D) Mouthwashing

2. What budget do reports give for A24's Elden Ring film?

- (A) $50 million
- (B) $200 million
- (C) Through 2028
- (D) A24's smallest budget yet

3. Which company will stream the Elden Ring film?

- (A) Amazon
- (B) Sony
- (C) A24
- (D) Netflix

4. What is Netflix making?

- (A) A live-action PUBG series
- (B) Sonic the Hedgehog 4
- (C) A Minecraft sequel
- (D) A film of Mouthwashing

5. What will Donald Glover do on the PUBG series?

- (A) Only watch it
- (B) Only play the game
- (C) Make a Minecraft sequel
- (D) He will help produce, write and direct it, and star in it too

6. Why are so many game movies being made now?

- (A) Because many filmmakers are older
- (B) Because earlier hits showed that game worlds can bring big audiences
- (C) Because theaters are closing
- (D) Because games have no stories

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: B 3: A 4: A 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):